

FAQ DOCUMENT

The A to Z of Karma

2nd Edition

by AiR – Atman in Ravi (Ravi V. Melwani)

Whatever You Do, Comes Back To You!

About This Document

This FAQ repository preserves the original wisdom of AiR's book 'The A to Z of Karma' through 10 key topics and 47 carefully curated questions and answers. Each answer is drawn directly from the book, with the exact page number and chapter cited for easy reference.

1. WHAT IS KARMA?

Q: What is the meaning of Karma?

A: What is Karma? Karma means action. It is doing. It is not just thinking. A thought is not Karma and neither is a feeling, Karma. When a thought becomes a feeling that leads to an action, that action becomes Karma. Karma is a very popular word in the world today because it has revealed the Law of Karma. The Law of Karma is the Law of Action and Reaction.

□ Source: Page 8, Chapter 1 — *The A to Z of Karma (2nd Edition)* by AiR – Atman in Ravi

Q: Is Karma just about human beings?

A: Nobody can escape from action. Every living being acts but it is only a human being who is capable of actions with discrimination. Animals, for instance, act out of instinct or some kind of a trigger but a human being not only thinks, he processes his thoughts and then, chooses his actions. These actions may be good or bad. Therefore, it is only human beings whose actions are Karma, not the inanimate world and not the other living organisms.

□ Source: Pages 8–9, Chapter 1 — *The A to Z of Karma (2nd Edition)* by AiR – Atman in Ravi

Q: Why is it important to understand Karma?

A: Every action has a reaction. Every act of ours is recorded and good or bad, we will be rewarded or punished for every deed, accordingly. A deed is like a seed. Just like every seed will sprout, every deed will bear fruit. But we don't realize this and therefore, pay scant attention to our actions. When we realize the truth of Karma, when we realize the A to Z of Karma or action, we will become conscious of everything that we do.

□ Source: Page 9, Chapter 1 — *The A to Z of Karma (2nd Edition)* by AiR – Atman in Ravi

Q: Can a person live without creating Karma?

A: Can a man live without action? No, it is impossible! For a man to be alive, grow and live, he must act. Therefore, it is a must for us to do good Karma. Man does not try to evade action because he realizes that it is not possible. You may be in action for a short period of time but you can't live without action, for long. Therefore, we cannot escape from action or Karma.

□ Source: Pages 20–21, Chapter 4 — *The A to Z of Karma (2nd Edition)* by AiR – Atman in Ravi

Q: Do thoughts create Karma?

A: We must be absolutely clear that thoughts do not create Karma. For this, we must understand the mind. Do we have control on our thoughts? Thoughts just pop up in our mind and while we cannot control thoughts from appearing, we can control our actions. Every thought need not become an action. Karma is action. Karma is not a thought. No doubt, the mind uses thoughts to create feelings and ultimately, actions but if we can use our intellect, which gets activated in the state of Consciousness, then, the thought will not become a Karma.

□ Source: Pages 55–57, Chapter 13 — *The A to Z of Karma (2nd Edition)* by AiR – Atman in Ravi

2. THE LAW OF KARMA

Q: What is the Law of Karma?

A: The Law of Karma is based on the principle, 'As you sow, so shall you reap. What you do will come back to you!' It is the Law of Action and Reaction. This law seems to have been created by the Creator of this universe. Just like there is the Law of Gravity that states that everything gets pulled to the centre of the earth due to a force called Gravity, the Law of Karma governs everything unfolding on the planet.

□ **Source:** Pages 11–12, Chapter 2 — *The A to Z of Karma (2nd Edition)* by AiR – Atman in Ravi

Q: Is the Law of Karma the same as luck or fate?

A: Nothing happens by luck or chance. Somehow the world believes a lot in luck and therefore, the businesses of astrology and palmistry thrive. Little do we realize that there is nothing like luck. It is all pluck. We will pluck our destiny depending on the deeds we plant, just as we pluck fruits depending on the seeds we plant. Have you ever seen apples growing on a mango tree? It is impossible. The Universal Law will not permit it. The Law of Karma is the law of the earth; we must accept it, respect it and live by it.

□ **Source:** Page 14, Chapter 2 — *The A to Z of Karma (2nd Edition)* by AiR – Atman in Ravi

Q: How does the Law of Karma work?

A: The Law of Karma is automatic, like any other Universal Law. It needs no intervention. It controls our death, our birth and how we will return to earth. Nobody can escape this law. The Law of Karma is like a boomerang with the principle, 'What goes around, comes around!' Based on our actions, good or bad, the Law of Karma will either reward us or punish us, respectively.

□ **Source:** Pages 17–18, Chapter 3 — *The A to Z of Karma (2nd Edition)* by AiR – Atman in Ravi

Q: Does the Law of Karma apply after death too?

A: The Law of Karma is unique. Not only does it apply during our lifetime but it is also responsible for our death, just as it controls our birth. When we die, our Karma doesn't get finished. We carry forward our Karma into a new life. Therefore, we cannot escape Karma even after we die. Until we realize the A to Z of Karma, we will never realize the truth of how it works.

□ **Source:** Page 13, Chapter 2 — *The A to Z of Karma (2nd Edition)* by AiR – Atman in Ravi

Q: Every action creates a reaction — what does this mean in practice?

A: As per the Law, every action will have a reaction. As you sow, so shall you reap. Therefore, what you do, is sure to come back to you. Everything that is happening in our life is happening because of Karma. Either it is our past Karma, our past actions that are unfolding or it is our present Karma that is the result of our own conscious choices. Let us know, beyond doubt that just as every seed will sprout, every action will result in a reaction.

□ **Source:** Pages 24–26, Chapter 5 — *The A to Z of Karma (2nd Edition)* by AiR – Atman in Ravi

3. THE THREE ACCOUNTS OF KARMA

Q: What are the three accounts of Karma?

A: Karma has 3 accounts. The first is Prarabdha Karma. It is the opening balance of our Karmic Account. The second is Agami Karma or the current account that accumulates the actions done in the present birth. The third account is Sanchita Karma, which is the corpus or the warehouse of our Karma. Together, these three accounts govern everything that unfolds in our life.

□ **Source:** Page 32, Chapter 7 — *The A to Z of Karma (2nd Edition)* by AiR – Atman in Ravi

Q: What is Prarabdha Karma?

A: Did you decide your birth? Did you decide how you came to earth? Did you decide your parents, gender or nationality? No! Then, who chose it all? It is Karma. Our past Karma doesn't disappear into nothingness. It becomes the seed that is planted for our future. Nothing happens by chance nor is there some distant God in a far-away heaven deciding our birth. It is our Prarabdha Karma or our opening balance that brings us to earth in a birth.

□ **Source:** Pages 32–33, Chapter 7 — *The A to Z of Karma (2nd Edition)* by AiR – Atman in Ravi

Q: What is Agami Karma and why is it the most important?

A: The second account of Karma is called Agami Karma or the current account. Everything that we are doing in life, our present actions are recorded in this account of Karma. Whatever is unfolding as our life is because of Prarabdha Karma or the opening balance, over which we have no control but we have complete control on our present Karma, the Agami or the current account of Karma. This Karma is an opportunity in our hands. We cannot change our past Karma but we have been given an opportunity to choose our present Karma and by doing so, create a destiny of our choice.

□ **Source:** Pages 35–37, Chapter 8 — *The A to Z of Karma (2nd Edition)* by AiR – Atman in Ravi

Q: What is Sanchita Karma?

A: There is a third account as well. It is known as Sanchita Karma. It is the account that is our warehouse or corpus, where we carry forward all the unsettled Karma from each life. When a man dies, he has some Karma that is unsettled. It may be good or bad. Death is sudden and there is always unsettled Karma that gets carried forward into our corpus or warehouse. This corpus is called our Sanchita Karma. Sanchita Karma is the Karma that we carry forward, life after life.

□ **Source:** Pages 39–41, Chapter 9 — *The A to Z of Karma (2nd Edition)* by AiR – Atman in Ravi

Q: Can we be free from all three accounts of Karma?

A: There is hope for this. It is called Enlightenment. When we realize the truth that Sanchita Karma doesn't actually belong to us, then in one moment we can be liberated from all Karma and from this continuous cycle of death and rebirth. When we are enlightened with the truth and

when there is the Realization that we are not the body, mind and ego, we attain Mukti. Not only are we free from Agami Karma, the current account or present Karma but we are also free from Prarabdha Karma, the opening balance and the accumulated corpus account, Sanchita Karma.

□ Source: Pages 41–42, 76–77, Chapter 9 & 18 — *The A to Z of Karma (2nd Edition)* by AiR – Atman in Ravi

4. KARMA, BIRTH, DEATH & REBIRTH

Q: Who decided our birth?

A: Did you decide your birth? Did you decide how you came to earth? Did you decide your parents, your siblings, your gender and your nationality? No, you did not decide or choose any of these. It was all decided by Karma. We pay scant attention to the truth that our birth is a result of our Karma. Somebody is born poor and somebody is born rich. This is not luck pressing the switch. If we are born blind, it is not because God is unkind. It is because of Karma.

□ **Source:** Page 47–48, Chapter 11 — *The A to Z of Karma (2nd Edition)* by AiR – Atman in Ravi

Q: Why do bad things happen to good people?

A: Bad things cannot happen to good people, just as apples cannot grow on mango trees. Such is the Universal Law. The law states, 'As you sow, so shall you reap.' Therefore, if bad things are happening, there is no other option but to believe that bad actions or Karma have been performed. Whatever is unfolding may be a result of past actions or actions done, long ago, which have either been forgotten or the actions of a previous life that were not settled. Good things and bad things happen not because people are good or bad, but because our past Karma is being settled.

□ **Source:** Pages 27–29, Chapter 6 — *The A to Z of Karma (2nd Edition)* by AiR – Atman in Ravi

Q: Does Karma carry forward after death?

A: What happens to our Karma when we die? Every 'body' dies, but don't we say, 'He passed away?' Who passed away? The one who was alive, left the body. If we are ME, the Mind and Ego that departs at death, we will carry our unsettled Karma, good or bad into our next birth on earth. The cycle of birth and rebirth is therefore, the method whereby, Karma is carried forward. Karma doesn't belong to the body. The body dies and returns to dust. The Mind and Ego, ME, carries its Karma and returns in a new body.

□ **Source:** Pages 59–61, Chapter 14 — *The A to Z of Karma (2nd Edition)* by AiR – Atman in Ravi

Q: How does Karma decide our next birth?

A: It is our own actions that determine who we are born as and where. Birth is just a reaction. Our actions of today, will be responsible for our next birth, just as our actions are responsible for how long we will live on earth. The cycle of Karma, death and birth will continue until we are liberated. As long as there is pending unsettled Karma in our Karmic account, we have to return to earth. The only way to be free from this cycle of Samsara is to transcend Karma.

□ **Source:** Pages 107–110, Chapter 26 — *The A to Z of Karma (2nd Edition)* by AiR – Atman in Ravi

Q: Why does the Karma cycle go on and on?

A: Only the body dies but the Mind and Ego, ME, will carry Karma and be reborn. It doesn't matter whether it is good Karma or bad Karma. As long as there is an action, there will be a

reaction. As long as there is cause, the effect must come. Every act, as we understand, becomes a seed and so every deed will bear fruit. The account of Karma will go on and on. If not settled now, it will be settled when we are reborn.

□ **Source: Pages 43–45, Chapter 10 — *The A to Z of Karma (2nd Edition)* by AiR – Atman in Ravi**

5. KARMA & SUFFERING

Q: Why do we suffer in life?

A: Everybody who is born on earth must suffer the triple suffering – pain of the body, misery of the mind and agony of the ego and our goal is to escape this triple suffering on earth and rebirth. But as long as there is Karma, we cannot escape rebirth. The cause of suffering is ignorance. We remain ignorant that we are this body, mind and ego. Therefore, we suffer the triple suffering on earth and return, again and again, in a rebirth.

□ **Source:** Pages 4–5, Introduction & Page 68, Chapter 16 — *The A to Z of Karma (2nd Edition)* by AiR – Atman in Ravi

Q: Does God decide our suffering?

A: It is nothing but our own Karma, the Law of Action and Reaction that is causing things to unfold in our life. Therefore, we must not make any mistake in understanding that there is nothing like luck, rather, our own unavoidable actions that are unfolding. It is due to our ignorance that we think that there is a distant God, somewhere up in the skies who controls our destiny. There is no God sitting up in the clouds micromanaging whatever unfolds on earth. Everything is controlled by Karma. Life is Karma.

□ **Source:** Pages 21–22, Chapter 4 — *The A to Z of Karma (2nd Edition)* by AiR – Atman in Ravi

Q: Is Karma a punitive law meant to punish us?

A: The Law of Karma is mistakenly thought of as a draconian law. Little do we realize that Karma is not punitive. It is reformatory. The purpose of Karma is not just to punish us, rather, to refine and reform us. Karma is like a bird which has two wings. One that punishes and one that rewards. The purpose of the 'Karma bird' is to teach us to fly in the sky, to realize the truth of 'Who am I?' and ultimately, be free from the Mind and Ego, ME and become one with SIP, the Supreme Immortal Power.

□ **Source:** Pages 71–74, Chapter 17 — *The A to Z of Karma (2nd Edition)* by AiR – Atman in Ravi

Q: How can we overcome suffering caused by Karma?

A: Those who understand Karma and its three accounts, learn to accept without protest. They realize that it is their own past actions that are appearing as a reaction and causing both, pleasant and unpleasant circumstances. While we have no control on our destiny that is unfolding based on our past actions, we have complete control on our present actions, our present Karma. We have an intellect that can discriminate and we have a willpower that can choose. Every action that we choose becomes a Karma.

□ **Source:** Pages 44–45, Chapter 10 — *The A to Z of Karma (2nd Edition)* by AiR – Atman in Ravi

6. IGNORANCE & REALIZATION

Q: What is the ignorance that traps us in the Karma cycle?

A: What is the ignorance that causes maximum confusion in understanding Karma? Somehow, we believe that doing good Karma will lead us to God. This is our biggest ignorance. What makes us ignorant is our mind. Our mind continues to make us blind and we become ME, the Mind and Ego. The cause is ignorance. We remain ignorant that we are this body, mind and ego. Therefore, we suffer the triple suffering on earth and return, again and again, in a rebirth. The truth is we are not the body, the mind, the ego. We are the Divine Soul.

□ **Source:** Pages 67–69, Chapter 16 — *The A to Z of Karma (2nd Edition)* by AiR – Atman in Ravi

Q: Does Karma belong to the body?

A: For most people, Karma belongs to the body. It is the body that acts. Is this true, in reality? The body is the instrument of action and no doubt, it performs the Karma but who is driving it to do the Karma? We are all controlled by our mind. The Mind and Ego, ME, is the creator of Karma and not the body. The answer is very simple. Karma belongs to the Mind and Ego, ME, not to the body. In the moment of death, the body returns to dust and Karma that is unsettled, good or bad, is the cause for us to be reborn.

□ **Source:** Pages 51–54, Chapter 12 — *The A to Z of Karma (2nd Edition)* by AiR – Atman in Ravi

Q: Who are we really — body, mind, ego or Soul?

A: The Soul has no Karma. It is nothing but a Spark Of Unique Life. The Soul comes from SIP, the Supreme Immortal Power and returns to SIP. Those who attain Realization of the truth, realize that they are not the body that dies. The body is nothing but over 30 trillion cells, made up of the 5 elements of nature. We must realize that we are not this body that we appear to be. We are the Power, the energy. We are the Soul. When we realize this, we are liberated from Karma, from all suffering on earth and ultimately, from the cycle of death and rebirth.

□ **Source:** Pages 92–94, Chapter 22 — *The A to Z of Karma (2nd Edition)* by AiR – Atman in Ravi

Q: What is the difference between knowledge and Realization about Karma?

A: Enlightenment will lead us to a state of Mukti or Freedom, Moksha or Liberation. We need Enlightenment to overcome ignorance. Without Enlightenment, we will never be free from Karma. Without Enlightenment, we will believe in the lie, we will die and never discover, 'Who am I?' We will live as the Body and the Mind and Ego, ME. The purpose of life is not achievement. The only way to achieve the purpose of life is to overcome ignorance and be enlightened with the truth.

□ **Source:** Pages 84–86, Chapter 20 — *The A to Z of Karma (2nd Edition)* by AiR – Atman in Ravi

7. FREEDOM FROM KARMA (MUKTI & MOKSHA)

Q: Can we be free from Karma?

A: Those who believe in the Law of Karma, often ask the most profound question, 'Can we be free from Karma? If the cycle of death and birth will go on and on because of our Karma, then, are we doomed to be in this cycle of Samsara, forever?' No! There is hope. It is possible to be free from Karma. As long as we think that we are this body, we will continue to accumulate Karma. But there can be freedom in action. We need to realize that we are not this body. We are just the Divine instrument. In reality, we are the Soul and the Soul has no Karma. Then we can transcend Karma.

□ **Source:** Pages 63–64, Chapter 15 — *The A to Z of Karma (2nd Edition)* by AiR – Atman in Ravi

Q: What is Mukti and how does it relate to Karma?

A: Our goal is Mukti. The purpose of a human being's existence is freedom, freedom from Karma. We can attain that state of Mukti, being liberated from Karma through what we call as Realization. When we are enlightened with the truth and when there is the Realization that we are not the body, mind and ego, we attain Mukti. What does this mean? It means that we are free from all Karma. Even though we are performing actions, we are not creating any fresh Karma because we have realized that we are not the body, mind and ego.

□ **Source:** Pages 75–78, Chapter 18 — *The A to Z of Karma (2nd Edition)* by AiR – Atman in Ravi

Q: What is Moksha and how is it different from Mukti?

A: What is Moksha? Is it the same as Nirvana or Salvation? These are different names or terms but they have the same meaning. They all refer to Liberation from the cycle of death and rebirth and Unification with God. Once we become a Jivanmukta, we have passed the first barrier. We have attained the state of Freedom or Liberation. Then, in the moment of death, not only are we liberated from all misery and free from all Karma but we are also free from the cycle of rebirth. We will not return to earth in a new body. This is Moksha, Nirvana or Salvation.

□ **Source:** Pages 79–82, Chapter 19 — *The A to Z of Karma (2nd Edition)* by AiR – Atman in Ravi

Q: Does doing good Karma lead to Moksha?

A: Many of us are caught in the myth that doing good Karma will lead to Moksha. As long as we do good Karma, thinking that we are the body, mind and ego, no doubt, we are creating good fortune in the future but we cannot attain Liberation or Moksha. If good Karma does not lead to Moksha, then, why is the whole world trying to do good deeds? It is because Karma is very important for our life to unfold. But ultimately, there is something better than just doing good Karma. It is transcending Karma. It is realizing that Karma doesn't belong to me.

□ **Source:** Pages 64–66, Chapter 15 — *The A to Z of Karma (2nd Edition)* by AiR – Atman in Ravi

Q: What is Liberation and Unification?

A: The purpose of our existence is to realize the truth that we are the Soul and reach the state of SatChitAnanda, that state of bliss that comes in truth Consciousness. In this state of joy we will experience an ecstasy that knows no pain. We will be free from another birth on earth. We will become one with the Divine. The wave that was otherwise, splashing on the beach, again and again, will stop splashing as it becomes one with the ocean. This simple analogy is meant to explain Liberation and Unification.

□ **Source:** Pages 97–98, Chapter 23 — *The A to Z of Karma (2nd Edition)* by AiR – Atman in Ravi

8. TRANSCENDING KARMA

Q: How can we transcend Karma?

A: To transcend Karma, we have to realize the truth that no doubt, the body does Karma but are we the body? No! If we believe that we are the body, then every action of ours is recorded as our Karma. The moment we realize that we are just an instrument and not the doer of action, the moment we realize that we are just the Soul and not the body, then it is no more our action, it is no more our Karma and we will not have to face the corresponding reactions of the actions that we do.

□ **Source:** Pages 111–113, Chapter 27 — *The A to Z of Karma (2nd Edition)* by AiR – Atman in Ravi

Q: What is a Karma Yogi and how does one live as a Divine instrument?

A: If one has understood the A to Z of Karma, then he transcends Karma, goes beyond the Law of Action and Reaction and lives as a Divine instrument of the Lord. One does not seek any rewards for their Karma, although they do good deeds. They realize that they are the Divine Soul and not the body, mind and ego that they appear to be. Being enlightened with the truth, they become a Karma Yogi, one who is ever-united with the Divine, doing Karma as an offering to the Lord. When one seeks no fruits for the seeds that they are planting, their deeds are no more Karma. Their actions become Karma Yoga.

□ **Source:** Pages 115–116, Chapter 28 — *The A to Z of Karma (2nd Edition)* by AiR – Atman in Ravi

Q: Is everything in life pre-determined?

A: Those who follow Karma, become so fascinated by it that they believe that everything is pre-destined. This is going from one extreme to another. If everything was pre-determined, then, we would be robots and not human beings. A human being has been given the power of discrimination. Man has the privilege to choose his actions. Everything is not pre-determined. We cannot control the rain but it does not mean we should get drenched. We can use our free will and open an umbrella. Man is the only being that has a fully developed willpower that comes from his intelligence.

□ **Source:** Pages 99–101, Chapter 24 — *The A to Z of Karma (2nd Edition)* by AiR – Atman in Ravi

Q: What is Twin Karma and how does it control our destiny?

A: Karma is not just actions of the past — it is twin Karma — actions that we have already done, which we cannot control and actions that we are doing and we will continue to do, over which we have complete control. Our destiny is controlled by twin Karma or the combination of our past Karma and present Karma. It is both, our past and present actions that become the twin karma that determine the destiny of our life. This means everything is not pre-destined or predetermined. We have a choice. By choosing our actions, we can change our destiny.

□ **Source:** Pages 103–106, Chapter 25 — *The A to Z of Karma (2nd Edition)* by AiR – Atman in Ravi

9. ENLIGHTENMENT & THE GURU

Q: What is Enlightenment in the context of Karma?

A: What is Enlightenment? The word 'Enlightenment' means to bring in the light of Truth. We need to realize that we are not the body that dies. We need Enlightenment to overcome ignorance. Without Enlightenment, we will never be free from Karma. The solution appears on the third and ultimate peak of Happiness, Enlightenment. A truly enlightened person knows that he is not the body that suffers physical pain. The ego that gets anguished is a false identity. All this is caused by the mind, which is an illusion. Realizing this is Enlightenment. It liberates us from all Karma.

□ **Source:** Pages 83–86, Chapter 20 — *The A to Z of Karma (2nd Edition)* by AiR – Atman in Ravi

Q: Why do we need a Guru to understand Karma?

A: To understand the A to Z of Karma, it is very important to have a Spiritual Master, a Mentor or a Guru. A Guru is one who takes us from 'Gu' to 'Ru', that is, from darkness to light. As long as we try to understand Karma ourselves, we will use our mind. Our thoughts will lead to confusion and therefore, there will be no conclusion. A Guru is the wise one. He is himself enlightened, has overcome ignorance and is a master of Karma. He can lead us from understanding Karma to finally, transcending it.

□ **Source:** Page 87, Chapter 21 — *The A to Z of Karma (2nd Edition)* by AiR – Atman in Ravi

Q: What is the role of the Guru in freeing us from Karma?

A: A Guru has a profound role in helping us overcome our ignorance and be enlightened to realize the truth. With the grace of the Guru, we can drop all our Karma – Sanchita, Agami and Prarabdha. All the Karma across lifetimes drops like a bag of potatoes into an ocean and sinks because of a Guru's grace. A Guru helps us to realize that we are neither the body nor the mind or the ego that carries the Karma. Because of Guru, we can be liberated from all Karma and be united with God.

□ **Source:** Pages 131–132, Chapter 21 FAQ — *The A to Z of Karma (2nd Edition)* by AiR – Atman in Ravi

Q: What is the need of Enlightenment in overcoming Karma?

A: We need Enlightenment to be free from Karma, to be free from all suffering on earth and also from returning in a rebirth. To be enlightened with the truth, we have to 'Ask' and 'Investigate'. We have to unlearn what we have learnt. We have to wipe out the myth that we have grown with. Most of us just live and die, without being enlightened with the truth. Therefore, even though we believe in Karma, we don't realize the A to Z of Karma. Then, we are reborn and this will go on and on.

□ **Source:** Pages 85–86, Chapter 20 — *The A to Z of Karma (2nd Edition)* by AiR – Atman in Ravi

10. LIFE, KARMA & PRACTICAL LIVING

Q: What is the ultimate truth — Life is Karma?

A: Having traversed the journey of Karma, A to Z, what is the ultimate Realization? It is this — Life is Karma. Everything in life is Karma. There is no Karma without life, just as there is no life without Karma. Anybody who is alive faces Karma. Our birth is because of Karma. We arrived on the planet because of our past Karma. Once we are born, we have to do Karma. We can neither be free from doing Karma nor can we be free from our past Karma. Karma is the essential law that governs all existence.

□ **Source:** Pages 119–120, Chapter 29 — *The A to Z of Karma (2nd Edition)* by AiR – Atman in Ravi

Q: If everything is Karma, is prayer or effort useless?

A: Just sitting and praying will not solve the problem. Because many of us depend too much on prayer, we underestimate the importance of Karma. No doubt, prayer itself is a good action and works after we have tried our best and finally, reach out to the Divine for intervention but if we do not do our Karma, then, even prayers won't work. So, do your best and leave the rest, to the Divine. There is an old saying, 'Pray as if everything depends on God but work as if everything depends on man.'

□ **Source:** Page 25–26, Chapter 5 & Page 50, Chapter 11 — *The A to Z of Karma (2nd Edition)* by AiR – Atman in Ravi

Q: Should we help people who are suffering even if it is their Karma?

A: When we help a suffering person, we should not worry about what their Karma is. We should only be concerned about what Karma we are creating. Therefore, being compassionate, serving the poor and the suffering can only create good Karma for us. It is wrong to think that by helping those who are suffering, we are interfering in their Karma.

□ **Source:** Page 127, Chapter FAQ Section — *The A to Z of Karma (2nd Edition)* by AiR – Atman in Ravi

Q: What is the purpose of human life according to the Law of Karma?

A: What is the purpose of our life on earth? Why were we given this human birth? Only man has a Divine purpose. The purpose of our existence is to realize the truth that we are the Soul and reach the state of SatChitAnanda, that state of bliss that comes in truth Consciousness. We must not waste this life. It is precious. We must not be caught in the web of Karma. To do this, we must be a master in the subject of Karma. The A to Z of Karma can lead us to our goal of Realization, Liberation and ultimately, Unification with the Divine.

□ **Source:** Pages 95–98, Chapter 23 — *The A to Z of Karma (2nd Edition)* by AiR – Atman in Ravi

Q: How should we accept our Karma without protest?

A: Whatever is happening in our life is nothing but a redemption of a past action. The universe is an organized place and everything is governed by the Universal Laws. Nothing in this world happens as random acts. Therefore, when we realize the truth that everything is controlled by

Karma, our own past actions, then, we will stop cursing, just as we will stop nursing and rehearsing what has happened. We will accept it as a reward or punishment for our own past deeds. Those who understand the A to Z of Karma, overcome ignorance and suffering.

□ Source: Pages 70, 109–110, Chapter 16 & 26 — *The A to Z of Karma (2nd Edition)* by AiR – Atman in Ravi
